



BUYERS' GUIDE

ESTYLE

Stylish, Affordable ENTRY-LEVEL LAPTOPS



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Are you someone who wants the best configured laptop in performance and storage, at the lowest price? Choosing between hundreds of laptops available at eye-catching prices, without knowing what goes inside it, could land you with a wrong one. This guide will help you through the know-hows of low-priced, entry-level laptops so that you may choose the right one to suit your requirement.

Long story short

Laptops have undergone many changes in their form factors but still fold like these used to. Their designers have done quite a bit of homework to make these look sleeker and lighter. Along with looks and style, in general, you can expect a phenomenal increase in processing power and user experience—all made available at low prices.

The word cheap is not a taboo anymore. Plastics, alloys, hinges, motherboard architecture, hardware and everything that keeps the laptop alive, including the software, are going through a slash in prices.

About two years ago, a normal desktop with about 4GB of RAM and 500GB of hard drive space was available for about ₹ 18,000. Now, spending on the costlier laptops is considered worth it because these are a total rip-off from the desktops' specifications two years ago. Technology is evolving and reinventing itself to be more adaptive to the economy.

Who prefers these laptops

It would be wrong to say that only kids and college students prefer owning these laptops. It is a great buy for programmers and coders as well. Enterprises

also love these as these require much lesser space and can be carried around for meetings.

Laptops in this price segment are best for low-memory, low-processor-intensive applications. You can opt for an up-grade later, which may be interesting but not advised.

What you need to look out for

Processors and cores. When it comes to processing power, most laptops have processors with clock speeds between 1.8GHz and 3GHz. These numbers may look fancy but when it comes to delivering the punch for running memory and processor-intensive programs, you may see your computer break down in the middle asking for a restart—maybe several times. The let-down is that there is no turbo boost, which may be a myth as it contradicts the application these are designed for.

RAM. Computers in this segment limit their volatile memory from 4GB to 8GB. It looks like everybody is happy with this specification for now.

Graphics. If you are a gamer, these computers would be a big disappointment. The onboard graphics are not high-performing, and you would be disappointed if you expect graphics that would run without freezing other applications. Popular processors from Intel, AMD or Broadwell give you basic performance and are primarily designed for everyday home and office computing. The only solace here is that these are the best fit for thin-and-light and business-class laptops that can handle basic graphics.

Inbuilt storage or eMMC. One of the major factors that are driving the costs down is the inbuilt memory. Manufacturers of certain laptops offer about 32GB of internal solid-state drive in this segment.

eMMC, a flash storage chip, has a lot in common with SD cards. It is a little slower

